

Question 51 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

State any two purposes of Training Needs Assessment.

Introduction

TNA is systematic finding of whether, who and what to train. For 8 marks, two purposes must be explained at length, then other purposes added. The two strongest: (1) identify genuine learning needs, (2) prevent training from being used as a false solution.

Detailed points

- 1. First purpose — identify genuine KSA gaps.** Using organisation, task and person analysis, TNA finds what knowledge, skill or attitude is missing, in which job, and in which people, relative to the standard of performance. This purpose gives HRD a map. Without it, programmes are aimed in the dark. Example: repeated billing errors might be a software-skill gap for new clerks only, not a ‘motivation problem’ of the whole department.
- 2. How this purpose is carried out.** Performance data, observation, interviews, tests, competency lists versus strategy. The formula standard minus actual is used carefully, only when the cause is KSA.
- 3. Second purpose — prevent wrong solutions.** The notes warn that training is not the answer to all company problems and that firms buy off-the-shelf programmes without checking relevance. TNA’s second purpose is diagnostic honesty: if the cause is a broken machine, a bad incentive, or shortage of staff, do not design a course. This protects money, time and HRD’s reputation.
- 4. Example of the second purpose.** A hotel’s front desk is rude because they are understaffed and punished for any delay, not because they have never heard of courtesy. A smile-training day would score well on reaction and change nothing. TNA should stop that design.
- 5. Further purpose — set objectives for design.** TNA supplies measurable learning and performance objectives. Design cannot start professionally without them.
- 6. Further purpose — select the right trainees and methods.** Not everyone needs the same programme. Skill vs knowledge vs attitude needs different methods. TNA guides both choices.
- 7. Further purpose — prioritise and create a baseline.** Critical jobs and large gaps first. Pre-training performance is recorded so evaluation is possible. Organisation analysis also aligns TNA with strategy.
- 8. Exam shape.** Two long purpose paragraphs with examples, then a cluster of design, selection, priority, baseline, strategy. Do not write two headings and one line each.

Conclusion. *Two main purposes of TNA are to identify real knowledge-skill-attitude gaps and to stop the organisation from using training as a false solution. Other purposes include setting objectives, choosing people and methods, prioritising, and creating an evaluation baseline. TNA is the first professional step in HRD training.*